

Now these tanks are notorious for leaking and leaching chemicals into the ground. Not only is it expensive to get one of these bad boys removed, but they are dangerous to you and the environment. And by expensive, we're talking \$50,000-plus.

- **Knob-and-tube or aluminum wiring.** These electrical red flags are a blast from the past, and oftentimes insurance companies won't insure properties with these relics still in place. If you happen to be a licensed electrician, go for it. If you're not, this is a huge expense that you probably don't want to deal with.
- **Water damage.** The severity of the issue can vary, but bad water damage can signify structural problems, roof leaks, or plumbing issues—all of which you should avoid. Your home inspector can advise you on whether any water damage signifies a larger issue.

EXERCISE CAUTION

Not every issue needs to be a deal breaker. Sometimes a lower price can be negotiated in exchange for taking care of a problem. (This also goes for the problems above, except meth. Just don't touch meth.) Here are some issues that you can overcome, but make sure you are aware of what you're getting into. Get multiple repair quotes before proceeding with your purchase, and definitely consider asking for a reduction of the home's price or a concession to cover the costs.

- **Mold.** These spores like to spread, and spread, and spread. However, some molds are worse than others. A mold test will determine what type (or types) of mold the home might have and what can be used to treat it. You can get rid of it, but it can be costly.
- **Radon.** This colorless, odorless, naturally occurring gas is difficult to pinpoint by location. While radon is more common in certain areas of the country, radon levels vary on a house-by-house basis. Your home can reveal off-the-charts radon levels, while your next-door neighbor has no radon at all. This can be remediated fairly easily and relatively inexpensively (closer to the \$700–\$1,200 range, which is not nearly as bad as some of the other things we've thrown at you). Your agent